

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, BHOPAL REGION,

I PREBOARD EXAMINATION 2024-25

CLASS X

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

(SET 3)

MAX MARKS: 80

TIME: 3 HRS.

General Instructions:

Read the instructions carefully .

1. This question paper comprises of 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.

2. The question paper contains THREE sections –

Section – A: Reading Skills (20 M)

Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 M)

Section – C: Literature (40 M)

3. Attempt questions as per the specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A

READING SKILLS (20 marks)

1. Read the following text.

10 M

1. The world is big but, in a sense, it starts with me. Knowledge and awareness about myself have to precede my knowledge of things other than me. If I want the external environment to appreciate value, I need to do it by myself, first. In order to make the atmosphere around me green, I have to be green myself in belief and action.
2. From dusk to dawn and dawn to dusk, our every activity leaves its footprints on the environment and ecology. It is a 24 x 7, eternal phenomenon. A laboured consciousness of having to go green in all possible areas is required in each one of us. It is, after all, our own self-interest and that of our descendants. The

conscious application of change is going to become a habit and one's culture in due course. Though we read and hear a lot of green initiatives, we hardly tweak our routines to suit the larger picture.

3. Greenery in the surroundings prevents dust and noise pollution. The way we water and manure plants also matters. Water is also a fast-depleting resource. Sprinklers are one example to use and conserve it. Compost from biowaste can be used as manure for plants which is cost-effective and eco-friendly. We can also contribute to the preservation of water bodies by not dumping our garbage in them. The use of public transport systems in place of individual modes can reduce carbon footprint.
4. 'Reuse', 'Recycle', 'Re-engineer' and 'Renew' are the mantras. Let us appreciate, support and contribute our might to the promotional efforts of the community in this direction. Remember, my ecology is also the community, society and nation that I care for which in turn cares for me. In other words, all these seemingly outward initiatives done for others are going to make my life more comfortable ultimately.
5. I have to be, therefore, concerned about what sort of environment I am responsible for, for my own sustenance, livelihood and progress. As long as my impact is positive, my presence will be welcome. If it is otherwise, I am going to be shunned. It is either 'Embrace' or 'Embarrass'.
6. Green initiatives are anti-scorch Earth. Air, water and soil need to be conserved for the thriving of mankind in the future. The increasing onslaughts on the quality of air and soil need to be reversed. The indiscriminate exploitation of water-consumable water is only 0.3% of fresh water- needs to be stopped. The Earth ought not to shrink further, continue to breathe easy. Mother Earth looks for only love and cares for her children and nothing more in return for all the wealth she has so generously showered on us.

Q1. Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- i. Why does the author say that one should be concerned about the environment? (1)
 - a) For future generations
 - b) For betterment of country
 - c) For the betterment of culture
 - d) For better sustenance

- ii. The writer is all for measures to be taken to save the planet Earth when he says, "Air, water and soil need to be conserved for the thriving of mankind in the future." (Para 6)
- State any two solutions he offers in the extract in about 40 words. (2)
- iii. Complete the sentence appropriately (1)
- We need to conserve water because _____.
- iv. The passage includes some words that are opposites of each other. From the sets(a)-(e) given below identify two sets of antonyms. (1)
- a) Belief and action
 - b) Knowledge and awareness
 - c) Reduce and increasing
 - d) Indiscriminate and change
 - e) Dusk and dawn
- v. Complete the sentence appropriately. (1)
- The author says that the Earth ought not to shrink further and continue to breathe easy so that_____.
- vi. Supply one point to justify the following in about 40 words (2)
- I need to do it by myself, first. In order to make the atmosphere around me green, I have to be green myself, in belief and action.
- vii. Why does the writer say, "The use of public transport systems in place of individual modes is a better option...."? (1)
- a) To manage ecosystem
 - b) To enhance air quality
 - c) To reduce carbon footprint
 - d) All of these
- viii. Based on your reading of the text, list any 2 preventive measures for the author's statement "Water is also a fast-depleting resource" in Paragraph 3. (1)

Q2. Read the following text. (10)

1. Renewable energy Sources, such as solar, wind and hydropower, have become critical for addressing global energy needs and combating climate change. Solar energy, for example, is growing rapidly, with global solar capacity increasing by 20% each year for the past decade. Wind energy, on the other hand, accounts for 8% of global electricity generation.
2. Renewable energy has significant environmental benefits, including reducing greenhouse gas emissions. Unlike fossil fuels, renewables generate power without releasing harmful pollutants into the atmosphere. It is estimated that switching to renewable energy can reduce global CO₂ emission by 40%.
3. Despite these benefits, challenges remain in the widespread adoption of renewable energy. High initial costs and the need for better energy storage solutions are two key obstacles. Additionally, the inconsistent availability of sunlight or wind in some regions makes it difficult to rely solely on renewables.
4. Governments and private sectors are investing in research and development to make renewable energy more affordable and efficient. Innovations such as advanced battery storage and floating solar farms are being explored. Several countries have set ambitious goals, aiming to source at least 50% of their energy from renewable sources by 2050.
5. Experts believe that the transition to renewable energy is essential for long-term sustainability. By continuing to develop and implement these technologies, the world can reduce its reliance on fossil fuels and create a cleaner, more sustainable energy future.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- i. What does the use of the phrase 'critical for addressing global energy needs' by the writer, in paragraph 1, tell us about the importance of renewable energy?
(1)
 - a. the writer is emphasising the essential role of renewable energy.
 - b. the writer is downplaying the significance of renewable energy.
 - c. the writer is questioning the reliability of renewable energy.
 - d. the writer is expressing doubt about the future of renewable energy.

- ii. Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below: (1)

ASSERTION: Renewable energy sources do not contribute to climate change.

REASON: Renewables generate power without releasing greenhouse gases or other harmful pollutants.

- A.** Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
- B.** Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
- C.** The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
- D.** The assertion is false, but the reason is true.
- iii. Identify the percentage of potential reduction in global CO₂ emissions that can be achieved by switching to renewable energy, as mentioned in the passage. (1)
- iv. According to the passage, what are two major challenges that hinder the widespread adoption of renewable energy? (1)
- v. Read the given prompt and select the correct option in the bracket to fill in the blank: (1)
- Global solar capacity has increased by 20% each year for the past decade, showing rapid growth in renewable energy.
- The percentage of global electricity generation currently sourced from wind energy is _____ (5%/ 8% /12%).
- vi. What are some of the innovative methods mentioned in the passage that are being developed to make renewable energy more efficient and reliable? (1)
- vii. Complete the sentence suitably. (1)
- Despite significant benefits, relying solely on renewable energy is a challenge in some regions because.....
- viii. Complete the following with a suitable reason: (1)
- Experts emphasise the importance of renewable energy because_____.
- ix. In the context of the paragraph 5, why is the transition to renewable energy crucial for long-term sustainability? (2)

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR**(20 marks)****GRAMMAR****10****Q3. Complete ANY TEN of the 12 of the following tasks, as directed.****(1 x10=10)**

1. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the blank 1

The story of English in India _____ between the conceptions of the language as an idea and as an object to date.

- a) will toggle
- b) have toggled
- c) had toggled
- d) toggles

2. Read the conversation between a man and his nephew. Rewrite the dialogue in reported form. (1)

Uncle: let us go and see the Great Apollo Circus this weekend.

Nephew: the ticket is on you because you lost all the games in cards yesterday.

Uncle invited his nephew to see the Great Apollo Circus coming that weekend but the nephew reminded him since he _____ on him.

3. Select the correct option to fill the blanks for the given line .1

He was tired and weak with hunger and he _____ not rise.

- a) could
- b) would
- c) need
- d) dare

4. Select the option that identifies the error and supply the correction for the following line from a news report- The cause of the Leicester clashes were ostensible tension after India Pakistan match. 1

Option no.	Error	Correction
a	Of	for

b	Were	was
c	tension	tensions
d	an	the

5. Complete the given narrative by filling the blank with the correct option

In the letter, the student has written that he _____ by some senior students who threatened him with dire consequences if he complaints. 1

- a) Is being bullied
- b) Have been bullied
- c) Was bullying
- d) Will have bullied

6. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket for the given portion of a letter: 1

Dear Sir

I would like to bring to your notice the unsanitary conditions in our colony. Rubbish and garbage _____ (lie) in heaps everywhere.

7. Report the dialogue between a student and a teacher, by filling the blanks in the sentence given below. 1

Student: I am so stressed before my board exams.

Teacher: Don't worry. We have arranged counselling sessions to de-stress you.

When a student admitted that he was quite stressed before his board exam, his teacher told him _____ because the school _____.

8. Identify the error in the given sentence from a newspaper report and supply the correction 1

I expect authorities to take action on this issue at the earliest or we would have to raise it on social media. (Use a given format for your response)

Error	Correction

9. Fill up the blank to complete the sentence with the correct option. 1

Mary often _____ to work by bus, but she _____ to work by taxi yesterday.

- a) Got, went
- b) Went, went
- c) Goes, went
- d) Has been going, reached

10. Read the following quote by a philosopher. Identify the error and supply the correction.

Man's goodness is a flame that must be hidden but never extinguished.(use the given format for your response.) 1

Error	Correction

11. Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue 1

I said, "I am not going to school."

Mother said, "Ok, finish all the household chores today and I will rest.

When I told mother that _____, she told me to finish all the household chores and that _____ rest.

- a) I'm not going to school, she would
- b) I was not going to school, she would
- c) I will not be going to school, she will
- d) I shall not be going to school, she planned to

12. Identify the error on a signboard in a parking lot and supply the correction. 1

Please pay your parking fee before exited.

Error	Correction

WRITING (10)

Q4. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below. (5)

- A. Your school has organised an educational trip to Fatehpur Sikri and Agra. You notice the dilapidated condition of some of the monuments. Write a letter to the Municipal Chairman of Agra mentioning the condition and requesting him to take urgent steps for the preservation of this valuable heritage. You are Anuj, resident of 40 Civil Lines Newtown, Delhi.

OR

- B. You are Anshika, a student of grade X and resident of 36D Ring Road, ITO, New Delhi. Recently you came across an advertisement by Set Fire Dance Academy, MG Road, New Delhi, which offers courses in various forms of dancing. Write an inquiry letter seeking information about the course and its package. (100-120 words)

Q5. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below. (5)

- A. 'Habits take time to develop. They do not happen overnight. When you find yourself engaging in an unhealthy eating habits, stop as quickly as possible as it leads to obesity.' Analyse the given statements and write a paragraph with the help of points mentioned below.

- Reinforce your new, healthy habits and be patient with yourself.
- Eat only when you are truly hungry.
- Plan meals ahead of time.

OR

- B. The following table gives information about some of the world's most studied languages. Write an analytical paragraph summarising the given information by analysing and reporting the main and relevant information.

s.no	Languages	No. of people studying	Native speakers of the language	Spoken in (No. of countries)

1	English	1.5 billion	527 million	101
2	French	82 million	118 million	51
3	Chinese	30 million	1.29 billion	33
4	Spanish	14.5 million	389 million	31
5	Italian	8 million	67 million	29
6	Japanese	3 million	123 million	25

SECTION D: LITERATURE (40 marks)

Q6. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for anyone of the two, given. (5)

A. Coorg or Kodagu, the smallest district of Karnataka, is home to evergreen rainforests, spices and coffee plantations. Evergreen rainforests cover thirty percent of this district. During the monsoons, it pours enough to keep many visitors away. The season of joy commences from September and continues till March. The weather is perfect, with some showers thrown in for good measure. The air breathes of invigorating coffee. Coffee estates and colonial bungalows stand tucked under tree canopies in prime corners.

(Glimpses of India)

1. What type of narrative style is used in the given extract to describe Coorg? (1)

Choose the most suitable option:

- a) Dialogue-based discussion
- b) Poetic verses with rhymes
- c) Descriptive, focusing on scenery and atmosphere
- d) Argumentative, presenting conflicting viewpoints

2. What do you understand by colonial bungalow? (1)

3. What can be inferred from the given line? (1)

“During the monsoons, it pours enough to keep many visitors away”

4. Describe Coorg in about 40 words. (as understood from the given extract) (2)

OR

B. And suddenly Bholi noticed that the teacher was standing by her side, smiling at her. "What's your name, little one?" "Bh-Bho-Bho-." She could stammer no further than that. Then she began to cry and tears flowed from her eyes in a helpless flood. She kept her head down as she sat in her corner, not daring to look up at the girls who, she knew, were still laughing at her. When the school bell rang, all the girls scurried out of the classroom, but Bholi dared not leave her corner. Her head still lowered; she kept on sobbing. "Bholi." The teacher's voice was so soft and soothing! In all her life she had never been called like that. It touched her heart. (Bholi)

1. What is the tone the teacher is UNLIKELY to have used in the line, "'What's your name, little one?'" (1)

A. reassuring

B. comforting

C. indifferent

D. calming

2. How does the author's use of Bholi's perspective help build the narrative in the extract? (2)

3. Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket.

The word 'flood' in the line '...tears flowed from her eyes in a helpless flood.'

Indicates that Bholi was crying (uncontrollably / unintentionally). (1)

4. How does the teacher's comforting demeanour contrast with the behaviour of the other girls in the classroom? (1)

Q7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two, given.(5)

A. Money is external.

He is learning, well behind his desperate eyes.

The epistemology of loss, how to stand up

Knowing what every man must know one day

And most know many days, how to stand up.

a) 'The boy is learning to stand up.' What does it mean in context of the extract? (1)

b) According to the poet, what do we mostly learn about loss from? (1)

c) Which poetic device has been used in third and fourth line? (1)

- i. Metaphor
- ii. Hyperbole
- iii. Personification
- iv. Enjambment

d) What does the boy learn by losing the ball according to the extract?

Answer in about 40 words. (2)

OR

B. "Belinda was as brave as a barrel full of bears,
Ink and Blink chased lions down the stairs,
Mustard was brave as a tiger in a rage,
But Custard cried for a nice safe cage."

(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)

- i. What does the use of conjunction 'but' in this extract signify? (1)
- ii. What is the significance of Custard crying 'for a nice safe cage'? How does this contribute to the overall mood and tone of the poem? (1)
- iii. Choose the most appropriate option. What does the extract demonstrate about other pets of Belinda? (1)
 - a) *The entire lot was as brave as could be*
 - b) *They all had flamboyant personalities*
 - c) *Ink, Blink and Mustard pretend to be brave*
 - d) *They were known for being fearful*
- iv. Comment on the boastful nature of the Belinda and her pets in about 40 words. (2)

Q8. Answer **ANY FOUR** of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. (4x3=12)

- a) What arguments does Anne present in the essay 'A Chatterbox'?
- b) What is Chubukov's guess about Lomov's purpose of visit? What does he say to himself about it?
- c) In Mandela's opinion, what are the 'twin obligations' that every man has in life?
- d) How is tea said to have been discovered in China?

- e) What do you think motivated the young seagull to make his first flight?

Q9. Answer **ANY TWO** of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. (2x3=6)

- a) What was the theory about viceroy butterflies? What were Ebright's findings on this project?
- b) How do we know that Noodle is very humble and wise?
- c) Why does Fowler say that Ausable does not fit into "any description of a secret agent"?

Q10. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words (6)

- I. Kindness and charity towards our fellow beings is a true religion. Discuss the statement in the light of the help received by Lencho from the Postmaster.
- II. Valli in 'Madam Rides the Bus' and Kisa Gautami in 'The Sermon at Banaras' learn an invaluable lesson about the life of mortals. Discuss.

Q 11. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. (6)

- I. Mrs Pumphrey's concern for Tricky was excessively indulgent and was nothing short of mania. Discuss.
- II. Hari Singh in "The Thief's Story" is a petty thief but Horace Danby and the 'lady in red' in "The Question of Trust" are seasoned criminals. Discuss.

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